in Britian. It was enough to stir the souls of even the less excitable Indian patriots.

The revenue contribution from Ratan's overseas acquisitions was telling. Under his leadership, the overseas revenue of the group, as a percentage of its total top line, grew from 24 per cent in 2004 to 57 per cent in 2010. When he hung up his boots in 2012, it was 60 per cent of a total that had itself seen dizzying growth (1,742 per cent) from 1992—giving lift to the global vision he had given clues of in 2004. In the process, he took India and the Tatas to the world.

This has made it more likely for the world to remember Ratan as the leader who gave the group more prominence and status amongst a larger population of the world, even more than Jamsetji did.

As Ratan stepped down, he set a turnover target of $500 billion for the group to achieve by 2022. It was a 400 per cent growth from what he had achieved in 2012 (a 1,742 per cent increase in revenue [1992–2012]). He left it to the future leaders to achieve the target of the Tatas becoming a half a trillion-dollar conglomerate. Whether the group's achievements in the time to come will be as portentous as the years under Ratan's stewardship were, will depend on how well his successors will take forward Ratan's vision.